How Clear Is Your Family on What Happens Next for Mom?

Twelve quick questions about what you have in hand. At the end: what you know, what's still unclear, and what to ask.

Answer yes, no or not sure. This checks how complete your family's picture is. It doesn't measure Mom's finances, and nothing here says whether she is eligible for anything.

1. Do you have Mom's care situation written down in a few lines: where she is, what help she gets, and what the facility has told you?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

2. Do you have a rough picture of her finances written down, even in round numbers?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

3. Have you written down what you've been told about Medicaid for Mom so far, and who said each thing?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

4. Do you have a list of the issues you've heard about, each marked as confirmed, assumed or unknown?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

5. Has someone who has looked at Mom's whole situation told you what needs attention now and what can wait?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

6. Do you know in what order things need to happen, from someone who has looked at the whole picture?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

7. Does each job your family has taken on have a name beside it?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

8. Do you know which of the decisions in front of you need a professional's review before anyone acts on them?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

9. Do you know which documents still need to be collected?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

10. Have you written down, in one place, any dates your family has been given by the facility, an agency or a professional?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

11. Do you know who you will ask about when to apply?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

12. If you asked each person in your family what happens next for Mom, would you hear the same answer?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

Answer the questions above and your page builds here.

WHAT YOU KNOW

WHAT'S STILL UNCLEAR

QUESTIONS TO CLARIFY

What this doesn't do

It counts what your family has in hand, not Mom's finances and not her eligibility. A low count means there are things still to find out or ask. Several of them, such as what comes first, the order and the timing, are what the planning conversation is for, so a “no” there is to be expected at this point. Nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice.

Ready for the next step?

You can see what your family has in hand and what is still unclear. The planning interview asks about Mom's situation and gives you a free planning report. Keep the page you just copied beside you while you answer, and bring both to your Medicaid planner.

Get Your Free Planning Report ›